

PHYSICAL STORE

Buy Physical Items — store section (ship / local pickup)

A dedicated “Buy Physical Items” section in the marketplace with two ways to get an item, full marketplace parity, serverless-GPU category tiles, and multiple payment options — including the legal, non-lending versions of “buy now, work it off.”

The section

- A new **Physical Items** department in the taxonomy (taxonomy.ts) so aiCategoryImages generates a **serverless-GPU tile** for it (and for “Buy Online & Ship” / “Local Pickup”) exactly like every other category.
- A PhysicalStore page (auto-routed; nav entry + a banner from the Marketplace) with a **two-option chooser**: (1) **Buy online & ship**, (2) **Buy locally & pick up**. Full parity: search, sort, localized pricing + country flag, listing grid.
- fulfillment_mode (“ship” | “pickup”) + pickup_location on listings (createMarketplaceListing); the store filters by mode and pickup orders route to local_pickup fulfillment.

Sort control + one-click Buy now

The results carry an Amazon-style **sort dropdown** at the top (Featured, Price ↑/↓, Avg. Customer Review, Newest, Best Sellers) via the shared src/lib/storeSort.js, and a one-click ✕ **Buy now** button on each card that logs the order immediately (no charge, no listing claim) and then prompts the buyer to complete the purchase. See STORE-SORT-AND-ONE-CLICK.md. Teen buyers’ orders route to their adult holder for approval before anything is reserved or charged (see HOUSEHOLD-TEEN-ACCOUNTS.md).

Payment options (credit card is the primary default)

1. **Credit card (default)** — real payment, +10% markup (STORE_MARKUP).
2. **Points / surveys only** — pay with earned closed-loop points.
3. **Affirm BNPL** — licensed third-party financing for real goods (off until merchant keys are set).
4. **Layaway** — reserve the item and pay it down with earned points BEFORE it ships.

Promotional (welcome) credit is applied automatically per the existing rules (platform-catalog items, per-order cap, USD-denominated, expiry, breakage).

Affordability warning

If an order total exceeds `PHYSICAL_AFFORDABILITY_LIMIT_USD` (default **\$1,460** — the reasonable annual-earnings figure), the buyer is warned before they commit that it's more than they can realistically earn/pay back in a year, and offered lower-cost options, Affirm, or layaway. It's a **warning, not a hard block** (they can proceed with acknowledgement).

Purchase Payback — the “earn it back” tracker (NOT a loan)

The user pays with their **own credit card** — the platform lends nothing and gives no money upfront. The Purchase Payback tracker then shows, as a motivational progress bar, how much they've **spent** (card/BNPL orders) versus how much they've **earned back** in closed-loop points they can spend on-platform. It is a **factual tracker of already-earned vs already-spent**, not a projection or a promise: the copy states plainly that it isn't a loan and that how much you earn back depends on your own activity. No guaranteed “cost to zero” claim (that would be an FTC earnings-claim problem).
`purchase_payback` flag.

Layaway — the legal “work it off” path (no credit extended)

Layaway means the buyer **receives nothing until it's fully paid** — so no credit is extended and it's not lending. They reserve the item and pay it down with earned points; when fully paid it ships (or is ready for pickup). The plan's **required monthly payment is capped at `LAYAWAY_MAX_MONTHLY_USD` (default \$90)** — the term is stretched so $\text{monthly} \leq \text{that cap}$. Cancelling refunds paid points (closed-loop) and releases the item. Functions: `layawayStart`, `layawayContribute`, `layawayStatus` (also cancels). Welcome credit is computed at start to set the target and redeemed at completion.

Why the “negative balance” is legal here

The original “negative balance you work off” was reframed after clarification: it is **not** the platform fronting money (that would be consumer lending). The user pays with their own card; the “balance” is purely the Purchase Payback **tracker** of value they can earn back through normal, closed-loop points. Combined with Affirm (licensed BNPL) and layaway (pay-before-delivery), every “buy now / pay over time” need is met without the platform extending credit.

Flags & settings

Flags: `physical_store`, `local_pickup`, `layaway`, `purchase_payback` (all default on). Settings: `PHYSICAL_AFFORDABILITY_LIMIT_USD` (1460), `LAYAWAY_MAX_MONTHLY_USD` (90), `PICKUP_RADIUS_NOTE`, `STORE_MARKUP` (10%).

Honest note

Keep payback/earn-back language factual and conditional (“earn points toward what you spent — depends on your activity”), never a guaranteed payback. I'm not a lawyer; a quick framing review with counsel keeps the earnings-claim wording clean.